ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 5: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** inspire action in readers	Purpose.
2	**(d)** a story makes values memorable	Narrative.
3	**(b)** If she had given up, she would not have won the medal.	Had + would have.
4	**(c)** loss of mobility led to new freedom	Disability to possibilities.
5	**(a)** choosing care over rank	Symbol.
6	**(b)** Never had she imagined such success.	Inversion after negative adverb.
7	**(d)** they also challenge low expectations and need balanced support	Balanced view.
8	**(b)** to show society endorsing compassion	Social approval.
9	**(d)** Overcoming	Participial phrase.
10	**(c)** rejection of a deficit view	Reframing.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She stresses mindset and choice (1) although physical training was also necessary, so both matter (1).	1+1
12	Possibilities look forward (1) while limits look at what is lacking (1).	1+1
13	A medal becomes a sign of character (1) not of speed (1).	1+1
14	It focuses on achievements and choices (1) and uses empowering language (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It can motivate (1). It can also oversimplify struggle (1). The text balances by showing effort and support (1).	1+1+1
16	It is the goal (1). Crossing together redefines it (1). It becomes a line of unity (1).	1+1+1
17	Finishing (1). A gerund is a verb used as a noun (1). It is the subject of the sentence (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She acknowledges obstacles (1). She credits others (1). She links her success to wider change (1).	1+1+1
18	Simple vocabulary (1). Concrete images (1). The accumulation of small acts (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Dr Malik won an individual medal, whereas the runners won as a group (1). 'Whereas' shows contrast (1). Both are kinds of victory (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Her illness (1). Her redefinition of life (1). Her work with sport and society (1). Avoiding the 'overcoming' narrative (1). Larger message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Competition drives excellence (1). Kindness adds humanity (1). Fair play includes care (1). Limits of the model (1). Balanced view (1).	2+2+1
20	Opening background (1). Questions on challenge (1). Questions on sport (1). Advice (1). Closing note of hope (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem's example (1). Dr Malik's example (1). Message to students (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Treating the first piece as a story. 'The World of Limitless Possibilities' is an **interview** with Dr Deepa Malik, so answers should say 'she says' and use question-and-answer content.
- Mixing up the medal: Dr Malik won a **silver** medal in shot put at the Rio Paralympics (2016). Do not call it an Olympic gold; the Paralympics are for athletes with disabilities.
- Explaining 'ability beyond disability' as 'disabled people cannot work'. It means talent and strength go beyond physical limits, and sport changes how society sees persons with disabilities.

- Stating that the main hurdle was only the body. She points to society's attitude and underestimation; the answer must include resilience, treating setbacks as chances to grow.
- In 'Nine Gold Medals', saying one runner wins. The nine runners finish together, so **compassion matters more than winning**, which explains the title.
- Spelling and article slips: *Paralympic* (not 'Paraolympic'), *an* athlete, plural *medals*; do not mix up 'success' and 'failure' when asked for an opposite.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 5: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** plain narrative and restraint	Restraint.
2	**(c)** The runner who fell was helped by others.	Who fell.
3	**(c)** mindset can change what a person achieves	Premise.
4	**(c)** redefining success	Central.
5	**(b)** open to all	Open.
6	**(d)** to let the subject frame her own story	Voice.
7	**(a)** costs nothing and gains joy	Shared joy without loss.
8	**(d)** Redefining the Finish Line	Theme.
9	**(a)** inclusion needs both individual grit and social change	Both.
10	**(d)** against the odds	Idiom.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Action proves sincerity (1) and gives the moral without preaching (1).	1+1
12	The interview speaks to readers seeking guidance (1). The poem speaks to readers' hearts (1).	1+1
13	Individual effort cannot remove social barriers alone (1). Inclusive systems give equal chances (1).	1+1
14	By plain details of a race (1) that readers see in their own lives (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Self-belief begins action (1). Support sustains it (1). Both are needed for lasting success (1).	1+1+1
16	Realistic: such acts have happened (1). Idealistic: it presents perfect kindness (1). It shows what we can aim for (1).	1+1+1
17	A hopeful tone encourages (1). It avoids pity (1). It makes values attractive (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Words like 'unable' can limit (1). Words like 'ability' empower (1). Dr Malik chooses empowering words (1).	1+1+1
18	If the runners had finished first, they would have won in the usual sense (1). Third conditional marks the unreal past (1). Verb forms: had finished / would have won (1).	1+1+1
	OR: In the poem, the race is shared (1). It makes the group stronger (1). Shared joy lasts longer (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Individual grit (1). Social attitudes (1). Role of community in the poem (1). Need for change (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Interview: personal victory (1). Poem: shared victory (1). Common values (1). Differences in form (1). Your view (1).	2+2+1
20	Headline (1). Importance (1). Lessons from the interview (1). Lessons from the poem (1). Steps and conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). The game (1). The incident (1). The choice (1). The ending (1).	2+2+1

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 5: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** greatness lies in resilience and compassion	Synthesis.
2	**(a)** physical and attitudinal	Two kinds.
3	**(b)** the nine runners	Everyday heroism.
4	**(c)** a positive, encouraging tone	Tone.
5	**(a)** the runners who finished together	Cooperation.
6	**(d)** compassion and fairness	Values.
7	**(a)** anaphora, repeating 'We can...'	Persuasion.
8	**(d)** individual triumph vs collective triumph	Interview vs poem.
9	**(b)** helping a classmate who stumbles in a team activity	Application.
10	**(d)** central moral	Moral.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It shows models of respect (1) and asks whether we act as inclusively (1).	1+1
12	They show what is possible (1) and challenge low expectations (1).	1+1
13	The sense of unity (1) and the idea that all are winners (1).	1+1
14	It may ignore the athletes' skill and agency (1) and the structure of competition (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Sympathy looks down (1). Respect looks across (1). Dr Malik asks for respect (1).	1+1+1
16	The nine runners were cheered by the crowd (1). Object becomes subject (1). Verb takes 'were cheered' (1).	1+1+1
17	Interview gives facts (1). Poem gives feeling (1). Both complement each other (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Separate events offer fair competition (1). Inclusive events promote unity (1). A mix may suit different needs (1).	1+1+1
18	Falling, the boy cried out (1). The participle replaces a clause (1). The subject is the same (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Courage comes from within (1). Kindness acts outward (1). Together they make a supportive society (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Theme (1). Narrative form (1). Imagery and diction (1). Tone (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Background (1). Challenges (1). Role of support (1). Advice (1).	2+2+1
20	Shows action (1). Uses plain words (1). Lets the crowd respond (1). Leaves interpretation to the reader (1). Effect: sincere (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Dr Malik's compassion for others (1). The runners' compassion (1). Medals as symbols (1). Lasting impact of kindness (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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